XITAO WANG

MArch graduate (RIBA Part 2) from the Manchester School of Architecture, with a RIBA Part 1 degree from the University of Liverpool and international academic experience in the UK, Italy and Japan. Previous professional experience at Kengo Kuma & Associates and CCTEG Chongqing Engineering Group, contributing to design development, architectural visualisation, technical drawings and project documentation. Interested in sustainable design, adaptive reuse and multidisciplinary architectural practice, with a particular focus on the relationship between architecture, urban contexts and communities. Brings a combination of design thinking, technical understanding and visual communication skills, with experience working across different cultural and professional environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AutoCAD
Adobe Suites
BIM *(Revit)*
3D Design *(SketchUp, Rhinoceros)*
Rendering *(V-Ray / Enscape / D5)*
Microsoft Office Suites

KEY SKILLS

Design development and option testing
Architectural drawing production and technical documentation
Visual communication and presentation preparation
Brief interpretation and spatial strategy development
Multidisciplinary coordination with design teams and consultants
Sustainable design, adaptive reuse and retrofit awareness
Research-led design thinking and site analysis

EDUCATION

Sep 2024 - Sep 2026 **Manchester School of Architecture | Manchester, UK**
Merit, Master of Architecture (RIBA PART II)

Feb 2025 - July 2025 **Politecnico di Milano | Milan, Italy**
Master of Science, in Building Architecture
(Exchange Program Equals to Erasmus)

Sep 2021 - Jul 2023 **University of Liverpool | Liverpool, UK**
2:1 Honours Bachelor of Arts (BA), in Architecture (RIBA PART I)

Sep 2019 - Jul 2023 **Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University | Suzhou, China**
Bachelor of Engineering, in Architecture

Nationality: **Chinese**
Language: **English (Fluent), Mandarin Chinese (Native), Japanese (Basic)**

Tel.: **+44 (0)7840356494**
Email: **X.WangArch@gmail.com**

WORK EXPERIENCE

Kengo Kuma and Associates (KKAA)
Sep 2023 - Dec 2023 *Architectural Intern*

· Produced interior lighting design drawings and renderings for the Hangzhou Chaoyin Temple project during its final design stage, supporting the development of entrance and cantilevered ceiling designs from concept to technical resolution using Rhinoceros and Enscape.

· Prepared AutoCAD construction drawings for façade elements in the semi open car park and walkway areas, supporting technical coordination and cladding pattern development within the final design package.

· Supported weekly design review meetings with Mr. Kengo Kuma by preparing visualisations, option comparison boards and presentation materials for internal discussion and progress reporting.

· Produced plan and section drawings for Beijing Whitestone Gallery for KKAA publication and external architectural media, including the practice website and ArchDaily.

CCTEG Chongqing Engineering (GROUP)CO.,LTD
Jun 2021 - Sep 2021 *Architectural Intern*

Supported architectural design and drawing production within a professional practice environment. Attended site visits and coordination meetings, contributing to communication between the design team and client representatives. Assisted with drawing filing and progress schedules, developing an early understanding of project coordination, technical documentation and the practical constraints that shape design delivery.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS & ACADEMIC HIGHLIGHTS

Liverpool Architecture Festival Drawing Prize | 2023
Runner-up; recognized for excellence in architectural drawing and visual storytelling.

Hokkaido University Summer Institutes, Sapporo, Japan | 2024
Study on Ainu and Indigenous Cultural Heritage; focused on indigenous architecture and preservation strategies.

Architectural Short Film Competition, School of Architecture Liverpool | 2023
First Prize; short film exploring spatial narrative and human interaction.
Video link: ***https://youtu.be/znfRrTSLMCs***

Winter School, School of Architecture Liverpool | 2021
Work selected and displayed; thematic exploration of architectural narrative and expression.

2023-2026 SELECTED WORK

PORTFOLIO

XITAO WANG

PORTFOLIO

xtwangarch.github.io

00
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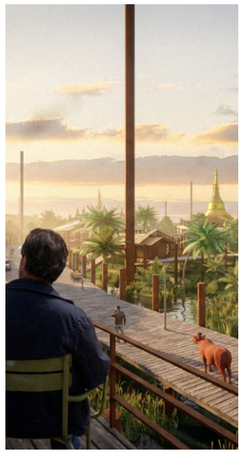
ACADEMIC WORKS

01

Mycelium Cave
Manchester

02

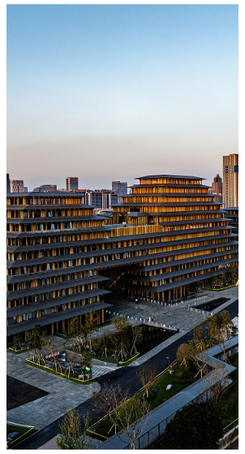
Paris Rive Gauche
University Complex



03

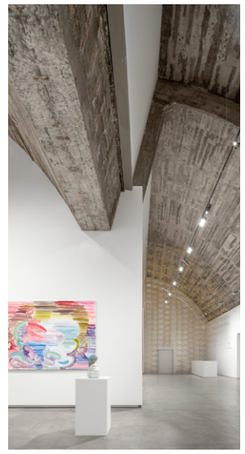
Elevated Village

PROFESSIONAL WORKS



04

Hangzhou Chaoyin
Temple



05

Whitestone Gallery
Beijing

01

Mycelium Cave Manchester

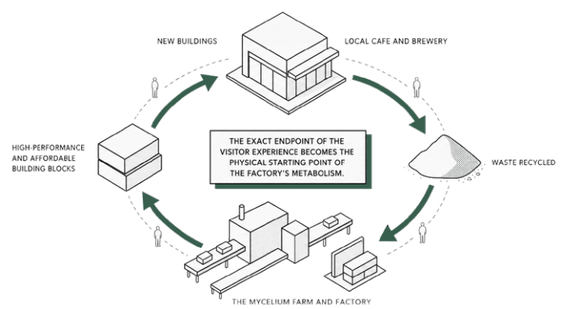
MARCH 2, ATELIER FLUX, MANCHESTER SCHOOL OF ARCHITECTURE

Mycelium Cave reimagines Mayfield's concealed under-arch spaces as a semi-subterranean bio-manufacturing landscape, positioned above the hidden, culverted section of the River Medlock. Occupying the overlooked railway bridge arch informally known as the "Bat Cave", the project treats the site's damp walls, darkness, moss growth and industrial remnants as active environmental conditions rather than constraints.

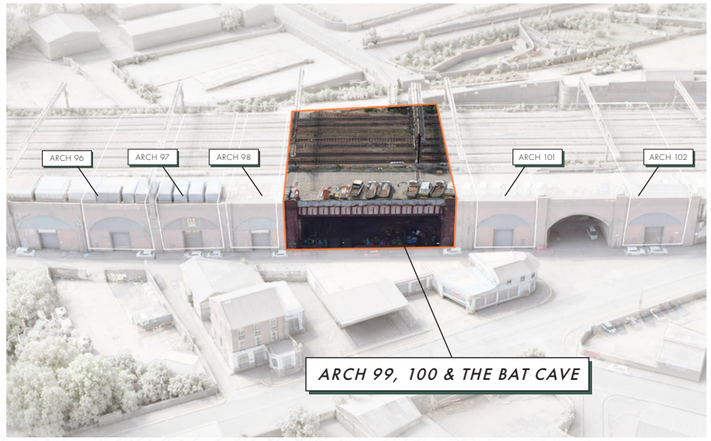
In the context of Mayfield, which used to be the industrial heart of Manchester, the project works because it does not erase the site's ambiguity or damage its existing fabric. Through light-touch, reversible interventions that can be adapted, removed or replaced, Mycelium Cave proposes a low-carbon, biodegradable and affordable material infrastructure for urban adaptive reuse and the protection of industrial heritage.

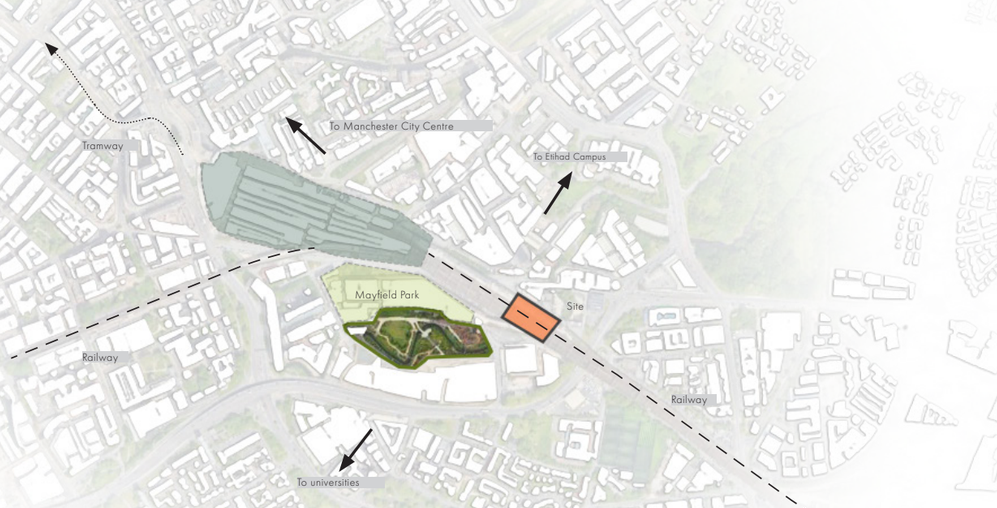
Project Type: Individual Work
Site Location: Mayfield, Manchester, UK
Year: 2025-26

Software used: Rhinoceros, D5 RENDER, AutoCAD, Photoshop, Illustrator

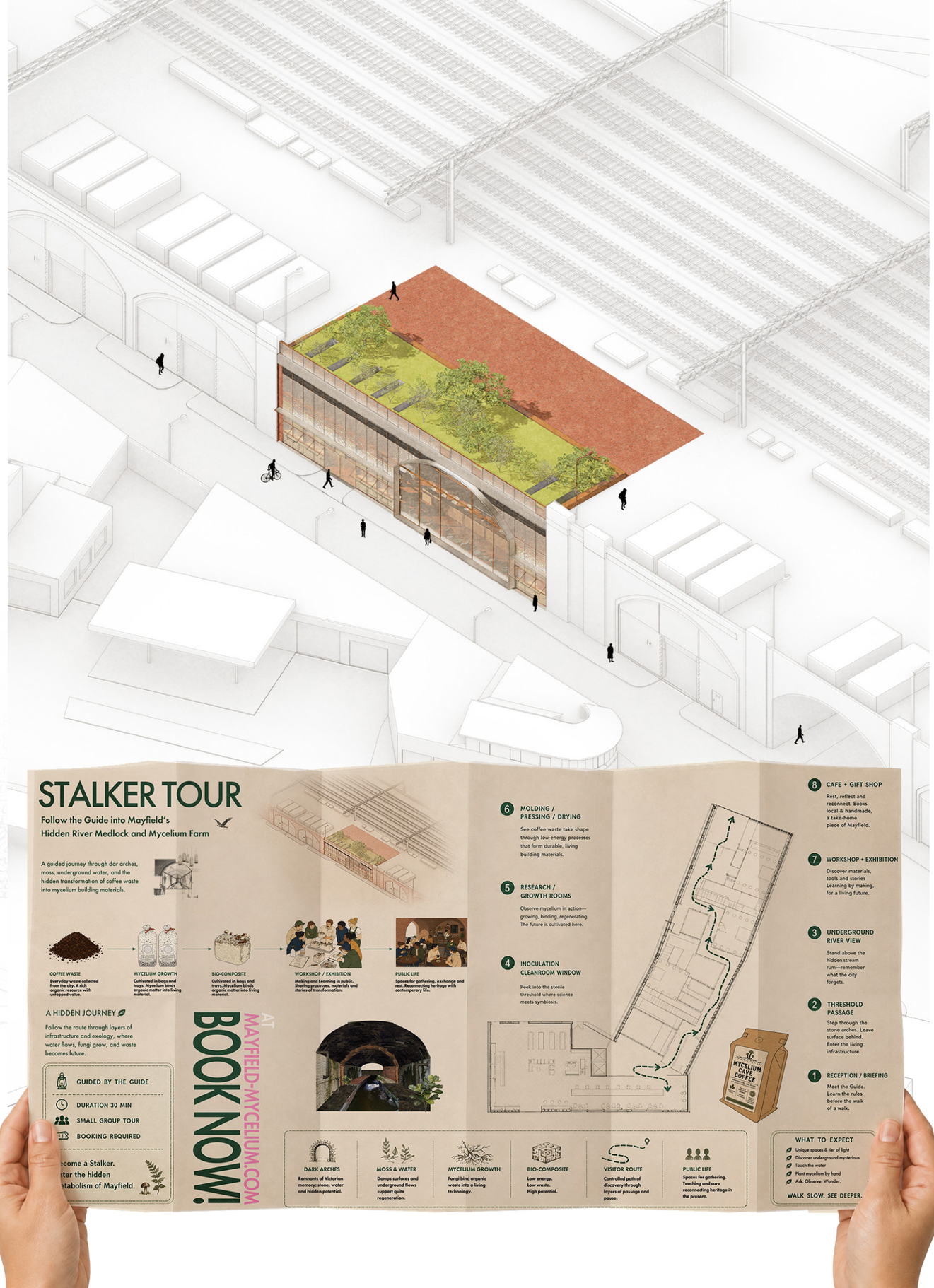


01
MYCELIUM CAVE MANCHESTER

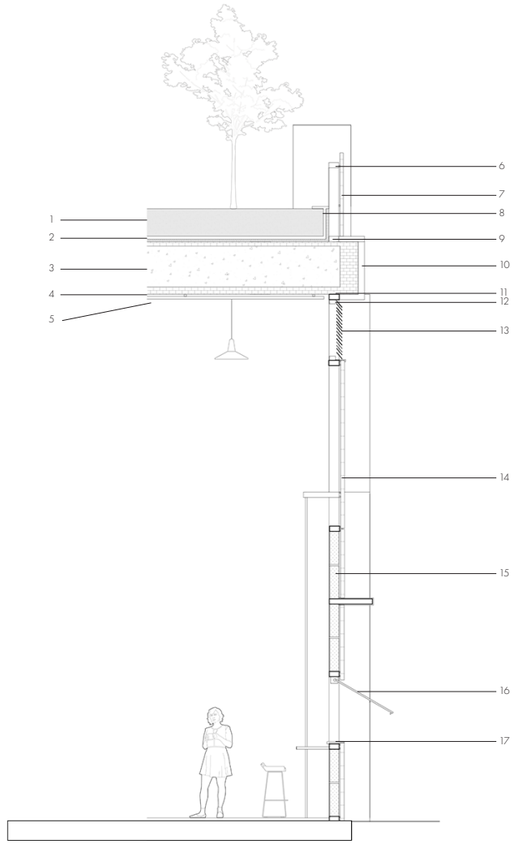




Within Mayfield's dark railway arches, damp walls and hidden voids, the project treats overlooked industrial remnants as an enigmatic field. The Stalker Tour guides visitors from public park to concealed production spaces, gradually revealing coffee-waste mycelium cultivation, material making and community learning as a regenerative urban metabolism.

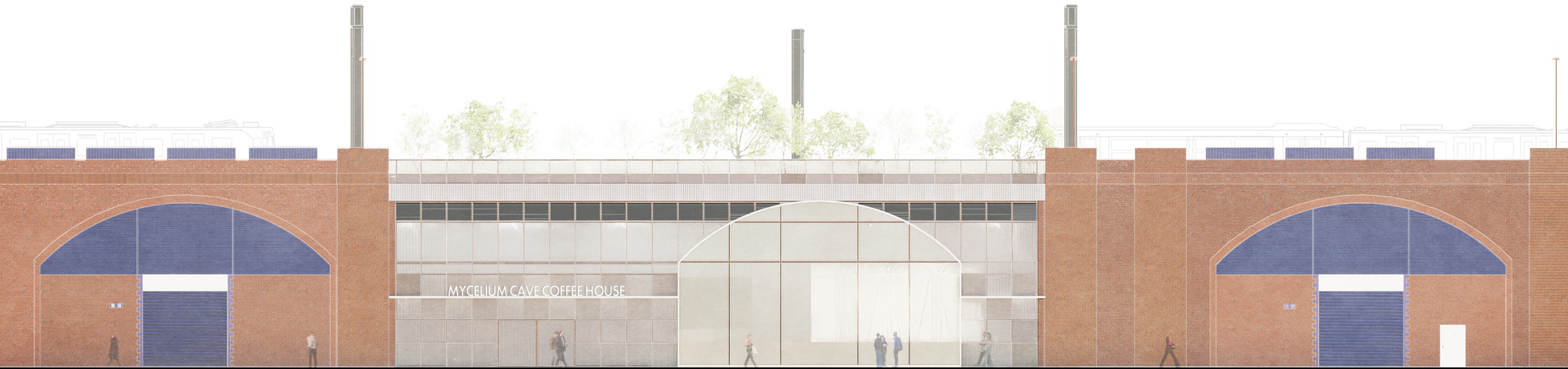


01
MYCELIUM CAVE MANCHESTER

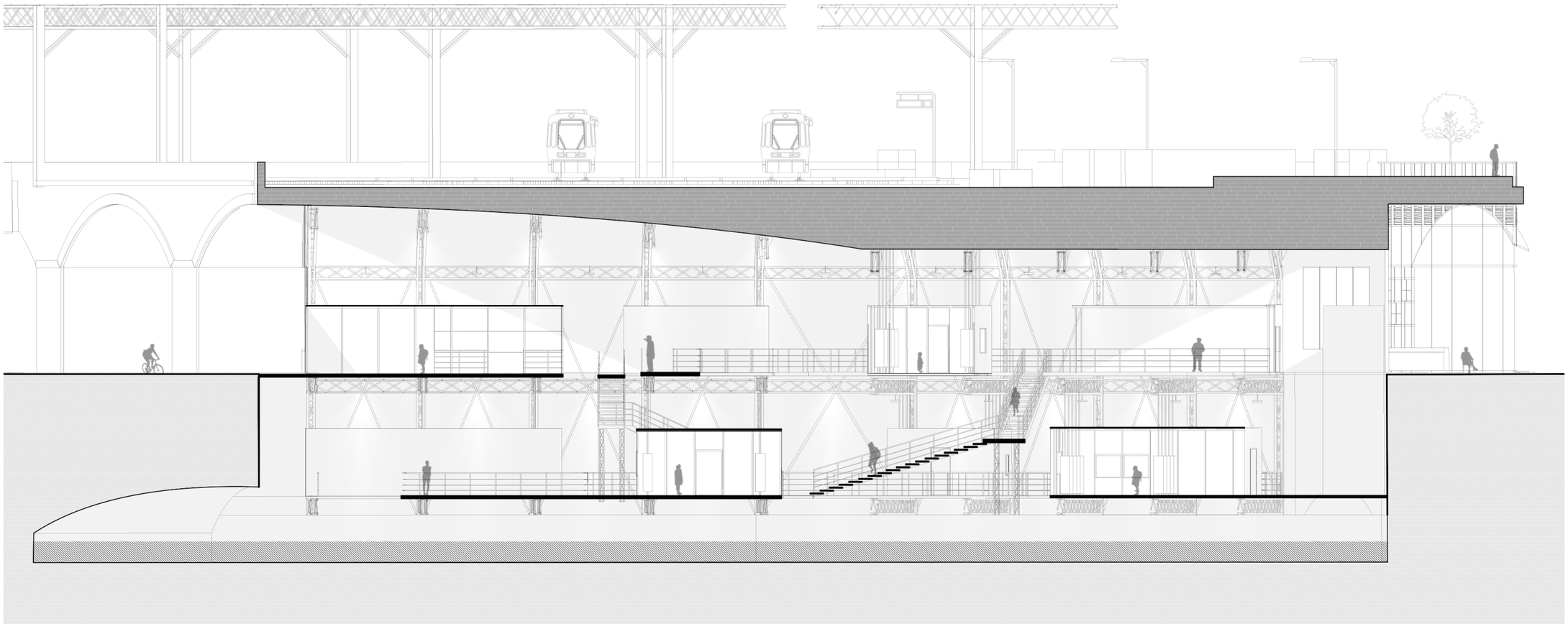


1 Soil
2 Waterproof membrane
3 Original Structure
4 Brick
5 Gypsum Ceiling Panel
6 Stainless Steel Frame
7 Polycarbonate Panel
8 Soil Container
9 Steel Gutter
10 Steel panel Cladding
11 Waterproof Layer
12 Light Timber Frame
13 Adjustable ventilation louvers
14 Polycarbonate Cladding Panel
15 Mycelium Brick
16 Window
17 Timber Framework

The facade mediates between Mayfield's heavy industrial fabric and the project's lightweight productive system. Existing brick and steel remain visible behind translucent polycarbonate panels, while timber framing softens the public edge. Mycelium panels act as experimental infill, allowing the facade to reveal cultivation, filter light and express waste as architectural material.

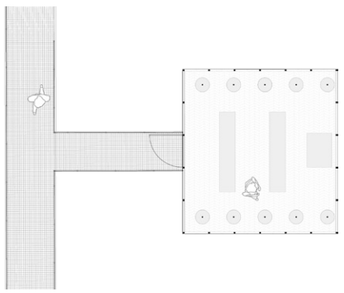


01
MYCELIUM CAVE MANCHESTER

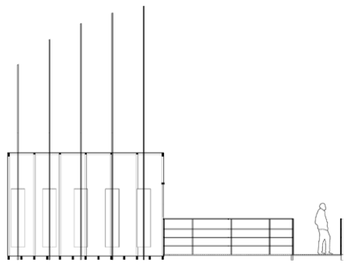


The key design strategy of this project is the insertion of a series of steel portal-frame trusses within the bridge arch, aligned with the direction of the tunnel and the underground river. These trusses act as an integrated spatial infrastructure, accommodating staff walkways, material transport routes, and visitor circulation. Moving between the river level and the surface level, the system weaves through the depth of the arch and generates a sequence of layered, mysterious underground landscapes. Each greenhouse, walkway, and truss component is carefully tailored to the site, prefabricated off-site, and assembled within the arch with minimal disruption to the existing structure.

01
MYCELIUM CAVE MANCHESTER



Independent mycelium cultivation greenhouses provide controlled temperature, humidity, and light conditions.



The translucent panels allow visitors to observe the internal growth process and lets light shine onto the bricks and the river.

02

Paris Rive Gauche University Complex

MSC, ARCHITECTURAL DESIGN STUDIO FOR COMPLEX CONSTRUCTIONS 1, POLITECNICO DI MILANO

Paris Rive Gauche Sorbonne University Complex reimagines a triangular block in Bruneseau Sud, in proximity to several universities and major railway stations, as a landscape-led urban connector between Massena and Ivry-sur-Seine.

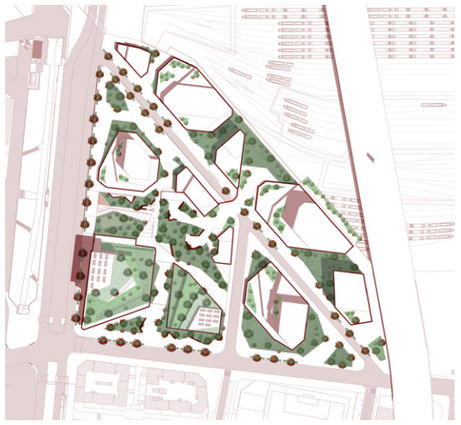
Rather than treating the university as an isolated academic compound, the project embeds it within a public green centre, transforming the campus into a civic landmark and a shared space for both the Sorbonne University's faculties and the surrounding neighbourhood. Through a continuous sequence of topographic landscapes, public gardens, and circulation ramps, the building extends the community park into its interior and turns the park itself into an open foyer for the university. Academic, research, and community programmes are interwoven along this spatial route, creating a porous urban campus where learning, public life, and landscape operate as one integrated system.

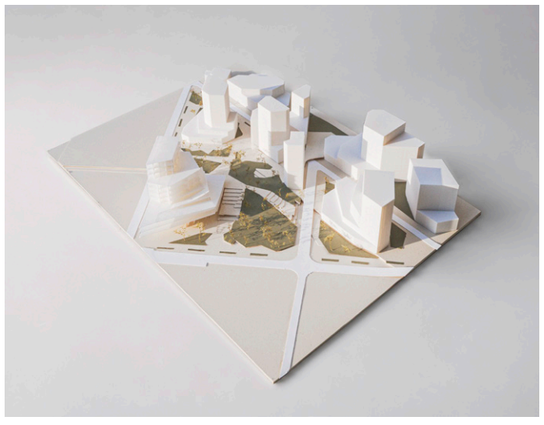
All drawings, models, and photographs presented here were produced by me.

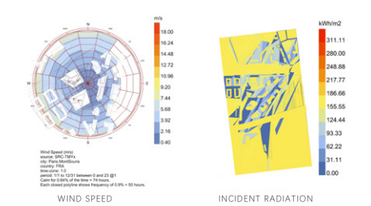
Project Type: Group Work of Three
Site Location: Massena, Paris, France
Year: 2025

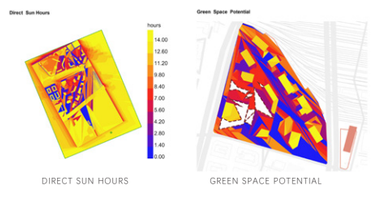
Software used:

02
PARIS RIVE GAUCHE SORBONNE UNIVERSITY COMPLEX



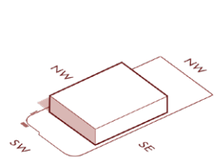




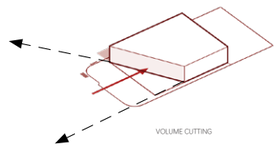


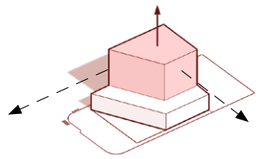
The masterplan establishes a continuous green civic courtyard. Generous public green spaces are introduced at the centre of the block, offering citizens shaded places for gathering, learning, and everyday use. Based on wind-speed and solar exposure analysis, the landscape strategy uses planted slopes, tree canopies, permeable surfaces, and open pedestrian routes to improve the local microclimate, reduce heat accumulation, and moderate wind conditions. The circulation ramps extend this green topography into the building, allowing the campus, park, and neighbourhood to operate as one sustainable urban ecosystem.

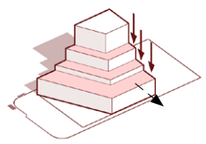
02
PARIS RIVE GAUCHE SORBONNE UNIVERSITY COMPLEX

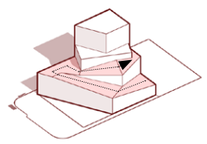


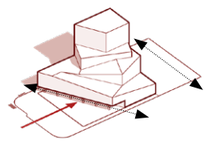
BASIC MASSING

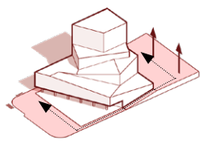

VOLUME CUTTING

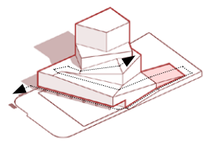

ELEVATE

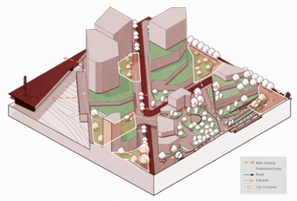

GENERATE STEPS

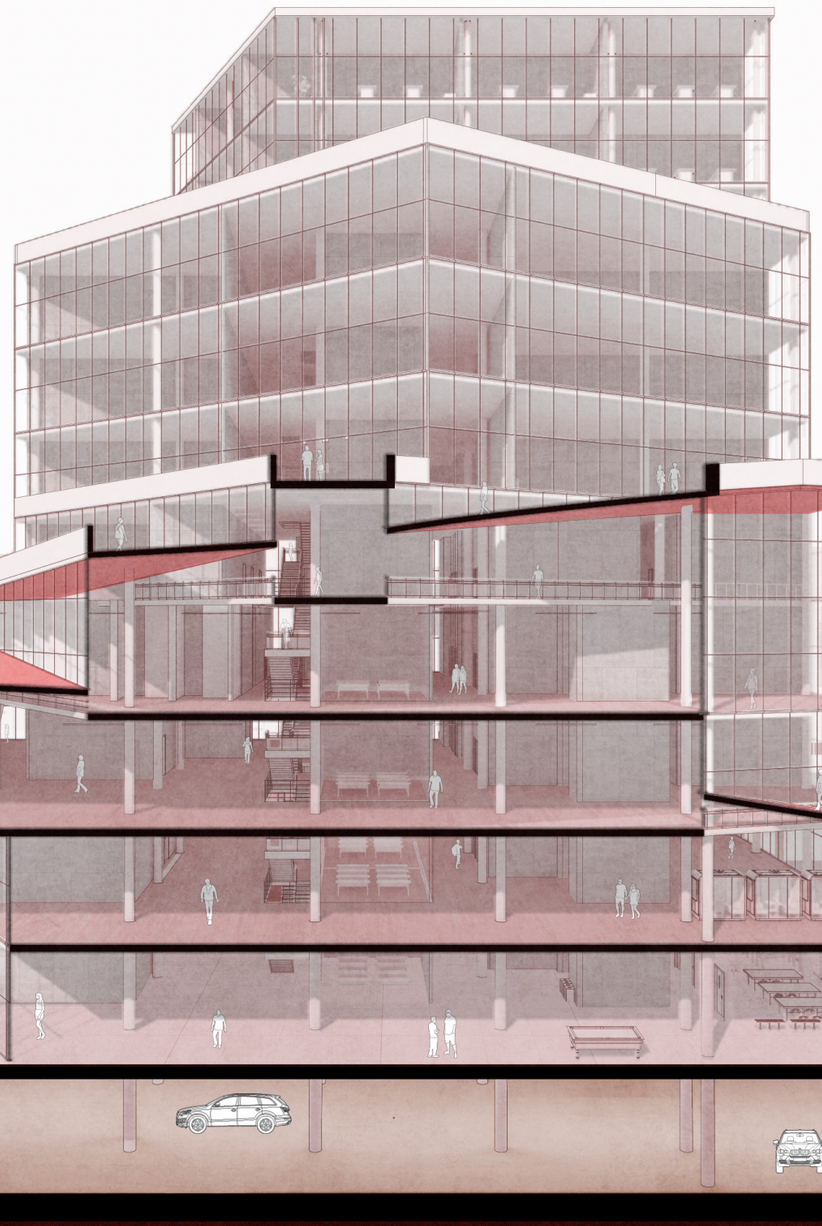

GENERATE RAMPS

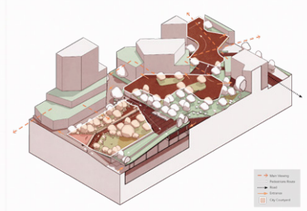

OPEN GROUND FLOOR

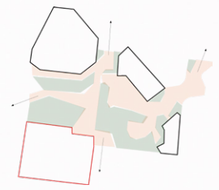

TERRAIN SOLUTION


FINAL MASSING



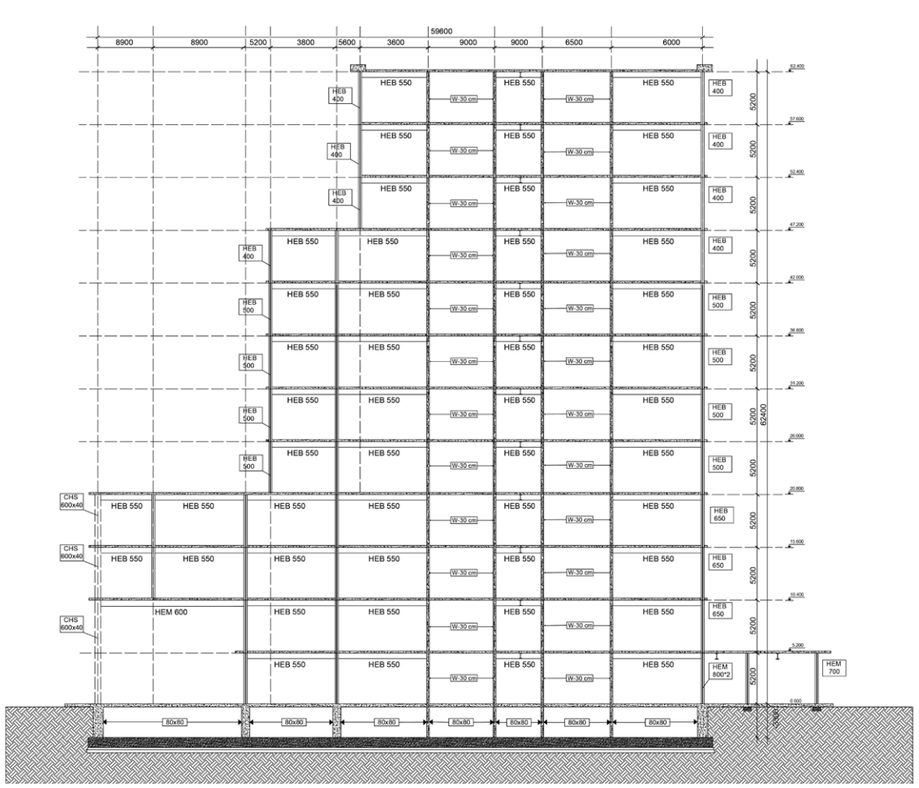


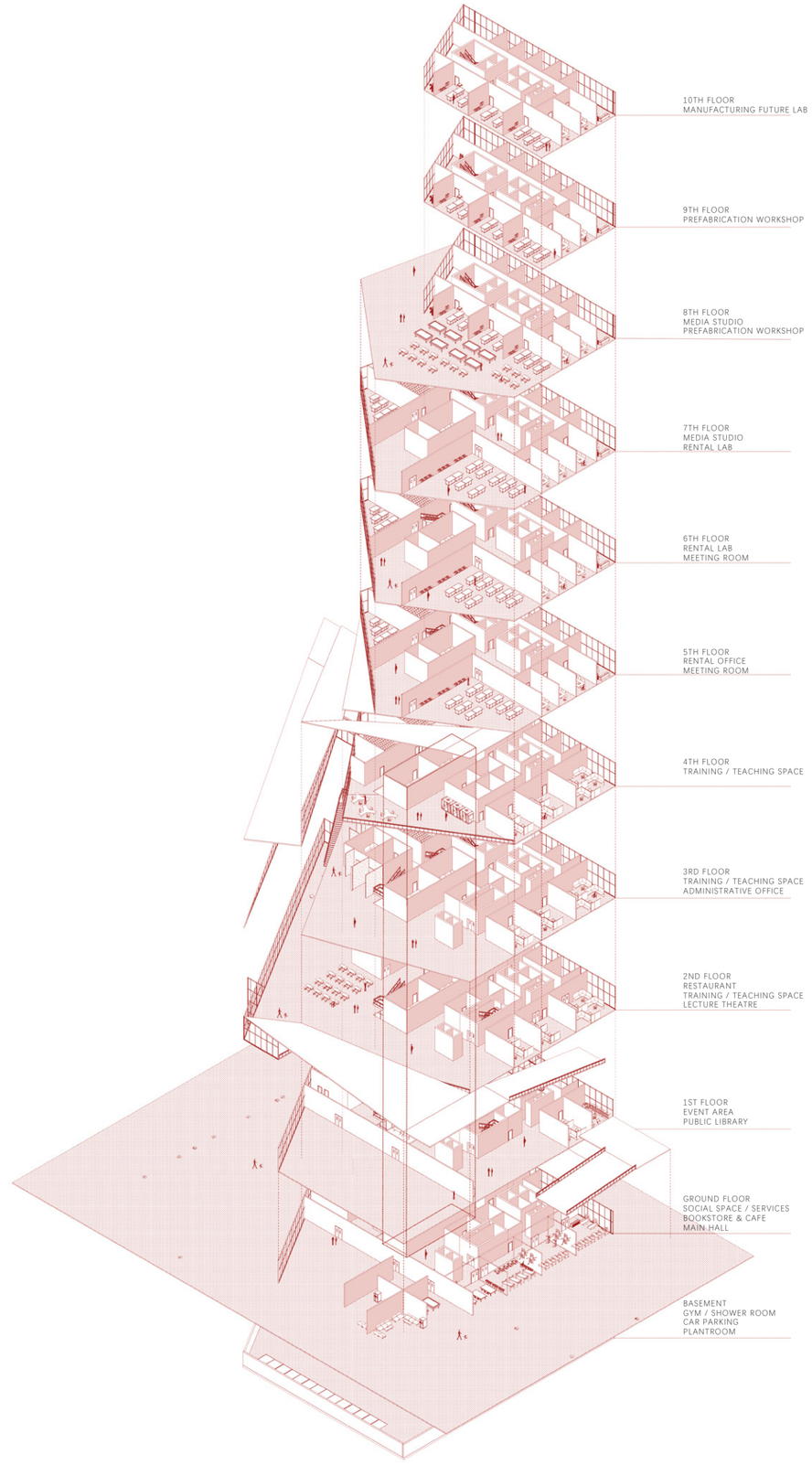




02
PARIS RIVE GAUCHE SORBONNE UNIVERSITY COMPLEX

A steel frame system with 9-metre grids, composite deck slabs, transfer beams, V-shaped CHS columns, and bracing supports long spans, flexible layouts, cantilevers, and lateral stability across the Main Building and Tower.





02
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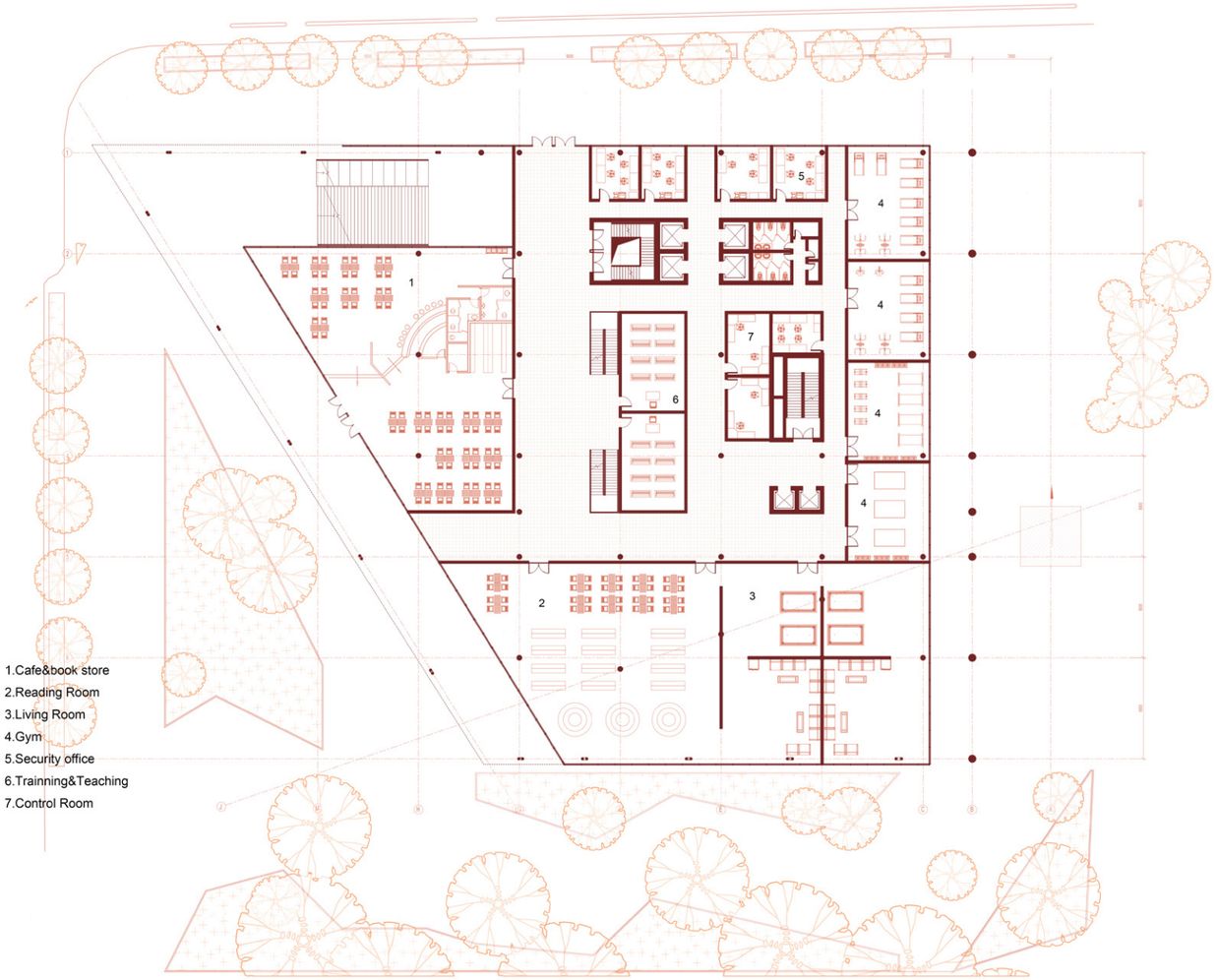
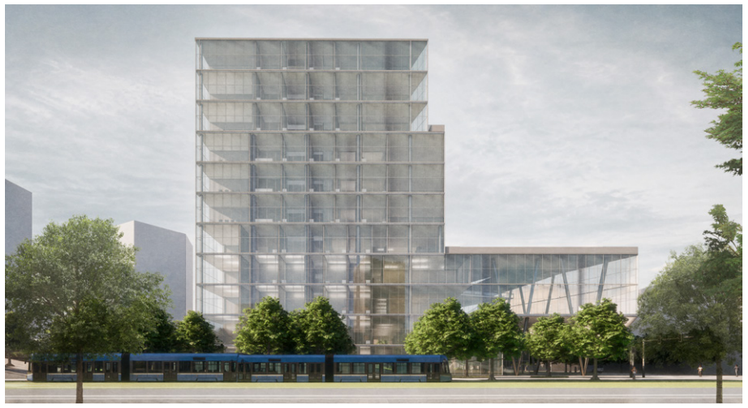
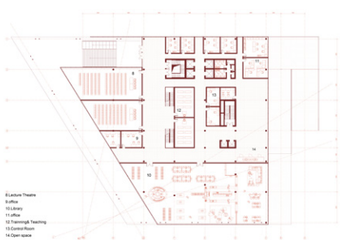
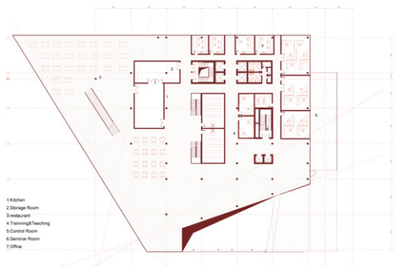
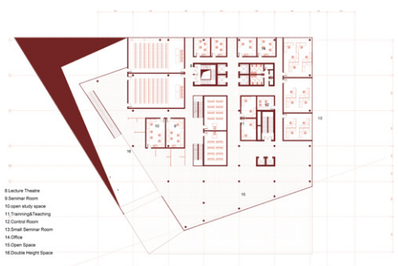










The production as the carbon driver, led by structural steel and glass facade systems. The facade strategy prioritizes rationalized glazing, modular components, recyclable metal framing, and improved insulation. Using rolling louvres and extending component lifespans allows the envelope to lower embodied carbon while maintaining daylight and thermal comfort.

03

Elevated Village

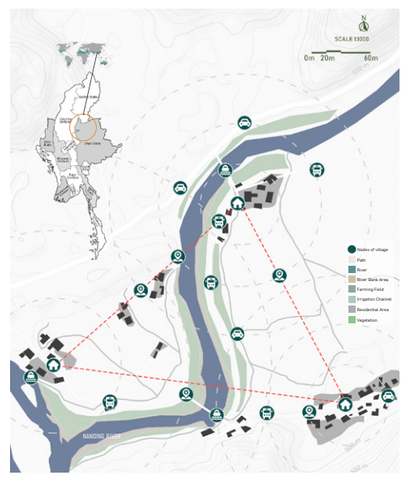
COMPETITION PROJECT

Located in a Shan village adjacent to the Nanding River in Myanmar, this competition project proposes an adaptive village transformation in response to seasonal flooding.

Rather than resisting water as a purely destructive force, the project reorganises the settlement, housing, public facilities, services, and infrastructure around the changing patterns of river flows. Through elevated ground, flood-resilient circulation, and distributed community programmes, the village is able to maintain daily life, production, and social activities during flood seasons while minimising disruption to its inhabitants. The proposal preserves the original cultural landscape of the Shan community and enriches village life through new shared spaces, creating a resilient rural settlement where living, working, and cultural continuity can coexist with water.

Project Type: Individual Work
Site Location: Gonepya Village, Shan State, Myanmar
Year: 2024

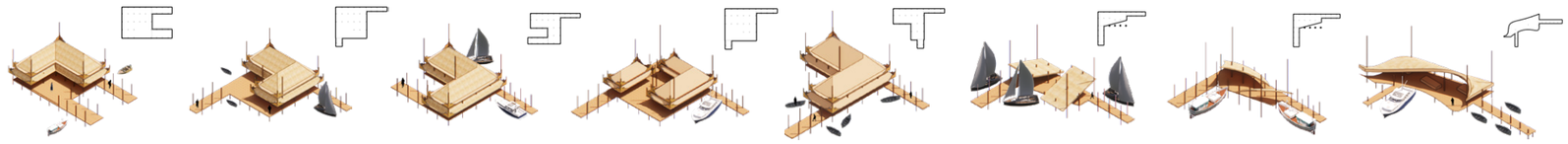
Software used:



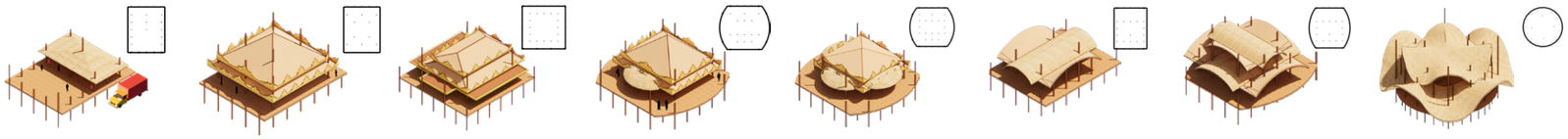
03
ELEVATED VILLAGE

RELIGIOUS PLACE / BUDDHIST TEMPLE

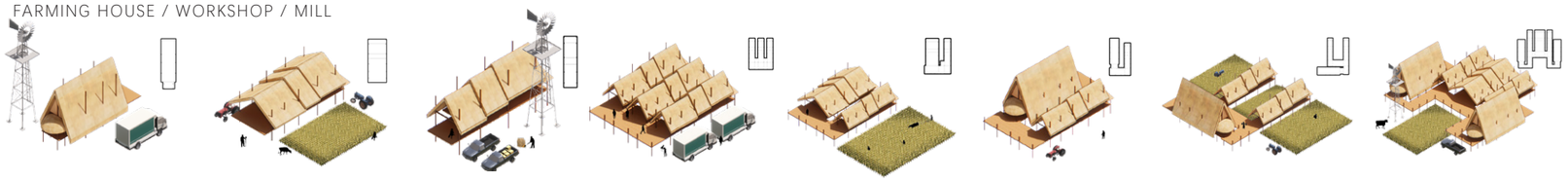
BRIDGE / DOCK



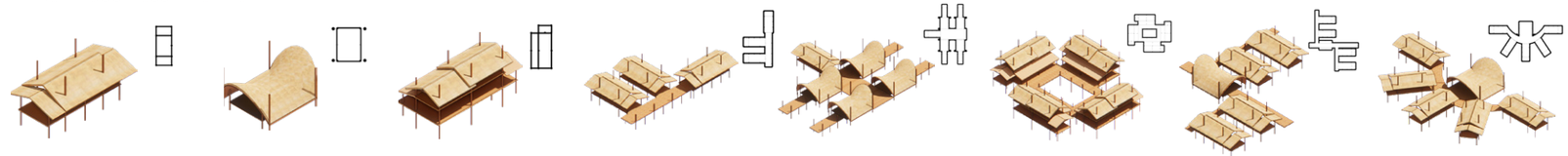
PUBLIC PLAZA / SCHOOL



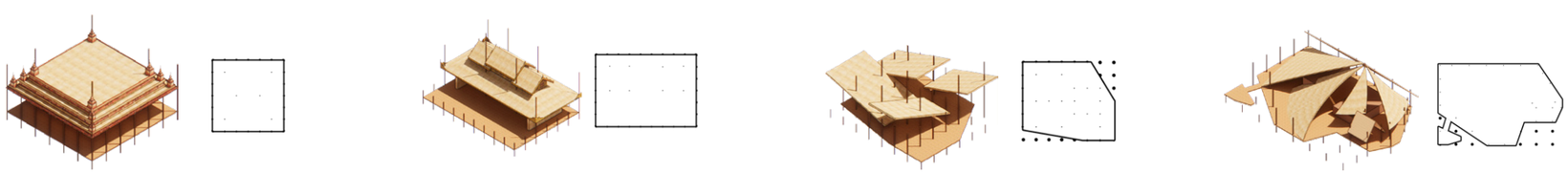
FARMING HOUSE / WORKSHOP / MILL



MARKET / BUSINESS / RETAIL

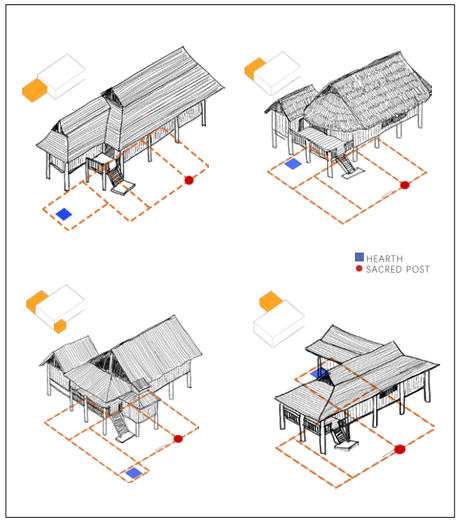


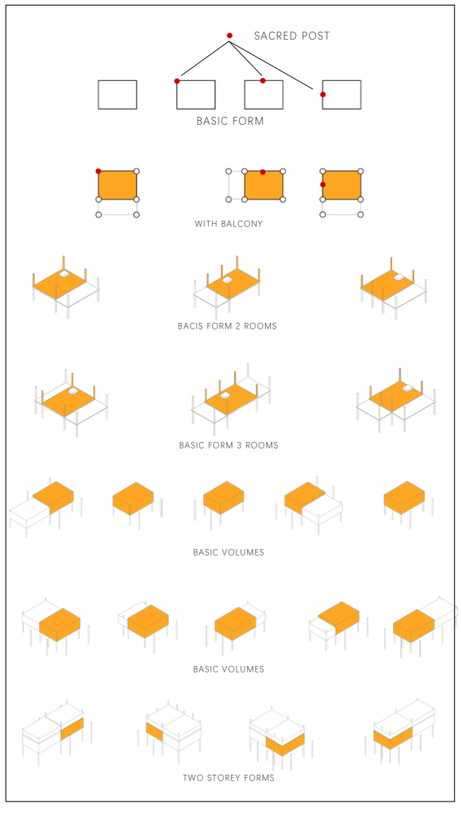
PUBLIC SERVICES / COMMUNITY CENTRE



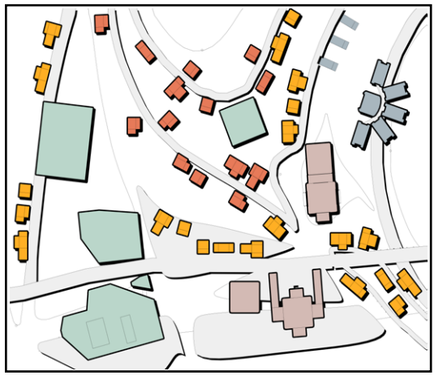
03
ELEVATED VILLAGE

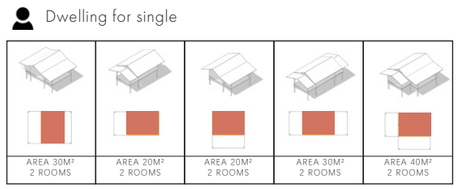
HOUSING FORMS

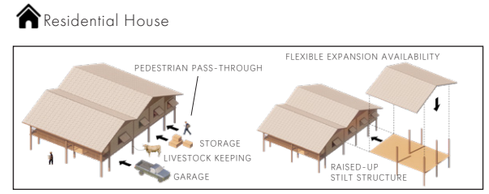


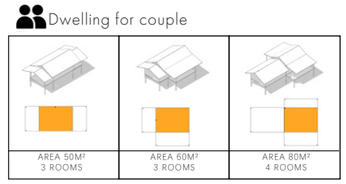


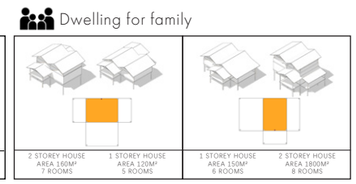
RESIDENTIAL AREA

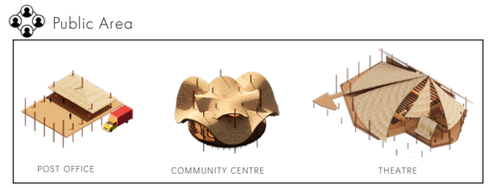


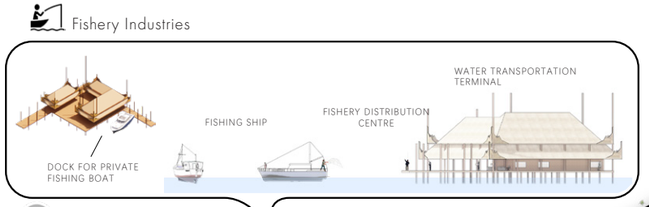


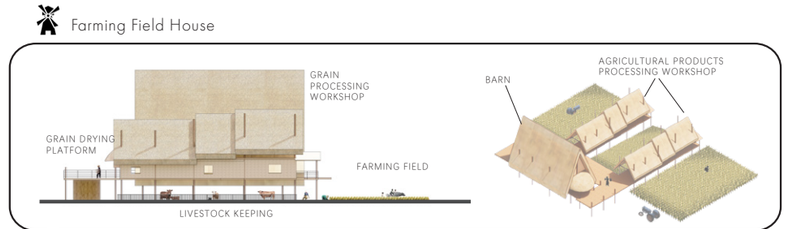


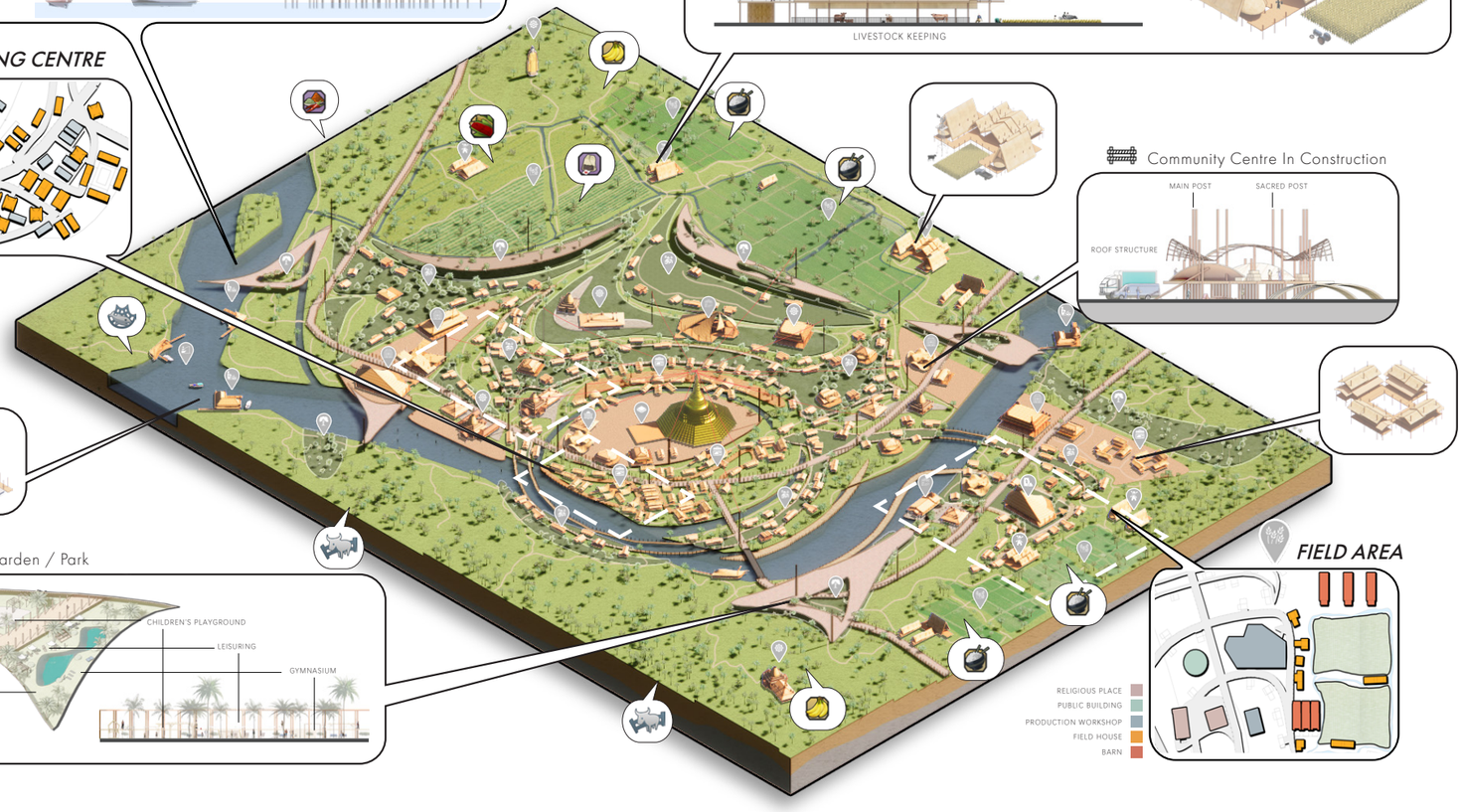


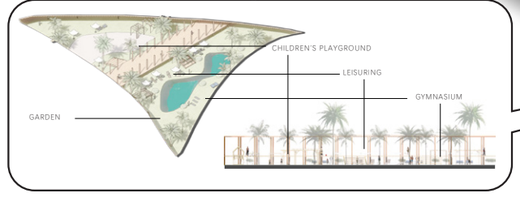








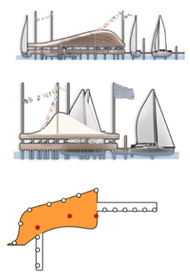


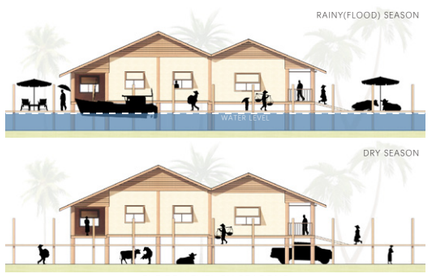


03
ELEVATED VILLAGE

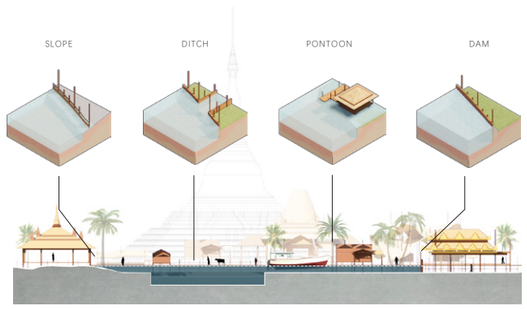
BRIDGE & DOCK

IN RAINY SEASON, WATER TRANSPORTATION BECOMES THE MAIN WAY OF TRAVELING, AGRICULTURE IS SUSPENDED AND FISHERY FLOURISHES, AND THESE DOCKS WILL BECOME THE HUB OF LIFE AND PRODUCTION.





FLOOD LEVEL BY SEASONS



FLOOD LEVEL SECTION

During the dry season, people engage in agricultural production and are connected to other surrounding villages through roads. During the rainy season, people's lives are elevated from the ground to modules connecting villages. People's living habits will be retained, and new industries will provide people with continuous income during the farm break.

Hangzhou Chaoyin Temple

INTERNSHIP PROJECT AT KENGO KUMA & ASSOCIATES, 2023

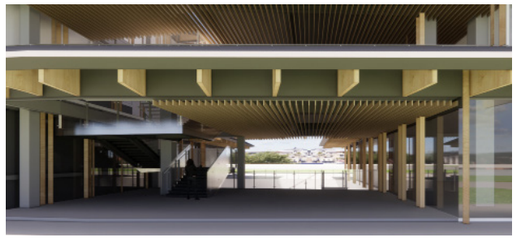
04

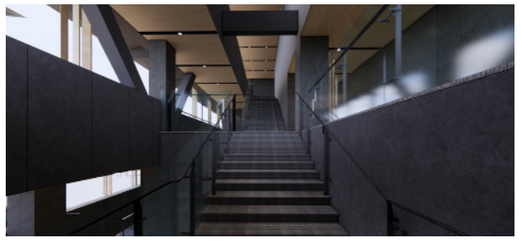
Location:	Hangzhou, Zhejiang Province, China
Architect:	Kengo Kuma
Year:	Ongoing
Status:	Final Design Stage
Use:	Religious / Culture / Hospitality

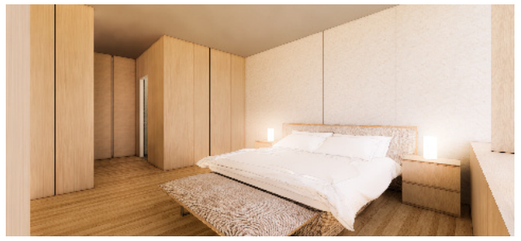
I was closely involved with this project in the final design stage. I produced interior lighting design drawings and renderings during its final design stage, and helped to finish a tectonic detail design of a wall finishing. supporting the development of entrance and cantilevered ceiling designs from concept to technical resolution using Rhinoceros and Enscape.

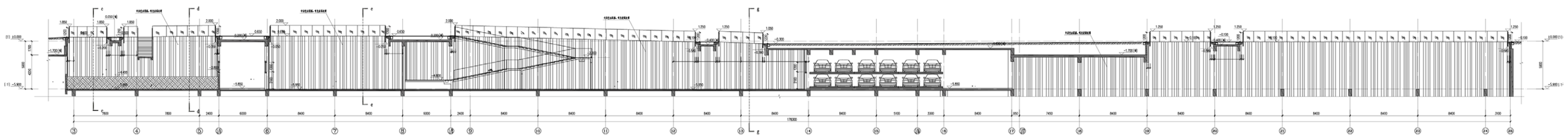
In the design of the Chaoyin Temple, we aim to create an "ancient temple courtyard" within a modern multi-storey building. Multi-story buildings often have repetitive and uniform spaces.

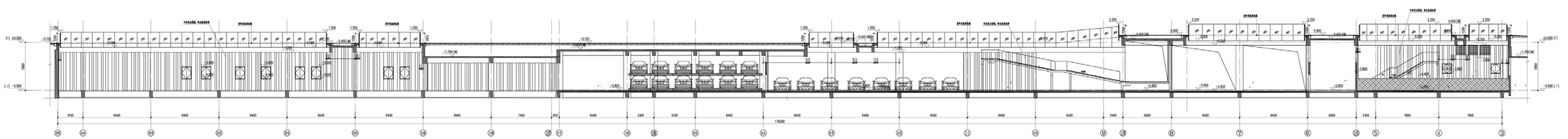
A three-dimensional touring route runs through the entire building, connecting the Buddha hall, resting spaces, and terrace spaces, creating a rich and experiential three-dimensional pilgrimage path. The eave style of traditional Chinese Buddhist pagodas outlines the exterior silhouette of the building, covering a variety of functional combinations. In this project, it is a challenge that the idea of how to create a three-dimensional "courtyard" and "city" that are usually developed horizontally, forming a dynamic functional collection.











Whitestone Gallery Beijing

INTERNSHIP PROJECT AT KENGO KUMA & ASSOCIATES, 2023

Location:	Beijing, China
Architect:	Kengo Kuma
Year:	2023
Area:	523 m^2
Status:	Completed
Use:	Gallery / Museum / Culture

After a site visit during my internship, I drew the final publication drawings, took part in the interior design stage, and finished the visualisation rendering for this completed project.

This project is located in Beijing's 798 Art District, an art district converted from a Bauhaus-style factory site. A three-dimensional canopy made of folded aluminium panels on the gallery facade has a wood grain texture, giving the gallery a strong landmark character. After entering the entrance, visitors will pass through a bamboo forest-like corridor created by wood grain strips and enter an open area under white walls and an arched roof. The rough, aged concrete is exposed, creating an impression of artwork floating in the space.